thamesview

Your magazine from Gallions | gallionsha.co.uk | July 2009



Summer family fun

Don't miss the Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival!

Opening soon...

The Gallions Furniture Bank

In the red?

Debt advice inside

Fire safety

Important information for everyone

Thamesview Summer 2009

Kidsview

Gallions Housing Association

Inside: Gallions and Axis partnership special, Rent to HomeBuy, Leaseholder secti

tw magazine

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Thamesview Summer Special

This issue of Thamesview is jam packed with great activities to keep you entertained all summer, whatever the weather brings! Make sure you check out pages 4-5 for all the gossip about the Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival this July and cut out and keep our events calendar, which is overflowing with good ideas for summer fun!

You can also find out the latest about our new furniture bank due to open in the autumn, read our top fire safety tips to help you protect your home and family and discover more about our repairs and maintenance service in the special Gallions and Axis guide.

Thank you to all of you who completed the Thamesview questionnaire in the last issue of the magazine – we had an overwhelming response and we are really pleased to hear that so many of you enjoy reading the magazine.

Your comments and ideas were absolutely fantastic and we are incorporating as many of your suggestions as possible into the magazine. Look out for the yellow 'reader idea' symbol as this shows where we have used your feedback to improve what we do. You can see the full results from the survey on page 15.

Congratulations to Amy Oliver of Hartslock Drive who was selected as the winner of our Thamesview questionnaire prize draw.

Gallions Housing Association

FSC Mixed Sources

GRB GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD APPROVED

Playground improvements



Gallions has recently been awarded funding, along with a number of other social landlords and organisations in the Bexley borough, to improve our play areas. The funding has been provided by Playbuilders, a government scheme and part of the national Play Strategy that aims to change the way children's play spaces are commissioned, designed and built.

Play areas in Aspen Green, Abbey Way and Glimpsing Green will soon be transformed to offer really unique play experiences. Overall, there are 27 play spaces in Bexley that will be developed or created and they will each be linked by an exciting story.

Our first play area to be improved is in Glimpsing Green and we are currently working on the detailed plans. The new style playground is due to open in spring 2010. If you would like to find out more or get involved contact Sue Asquith on 0800 83 84 81 or email sasquith@gallionsha.co.uk.

department for children, schools and families

Furniture wanted!

This summer Gallions is looking for good quality furniture that can be donated for our Furniture Bank due to open at 9 Tavy Bridge this autumn.

The Furniture Bank has been set up to help you recycle items you no longer want and to provide others with access to free household items that are desperately needed. We are looking for the following items as long as they are in a good condition:

- **Tables**
- **Chairs**
- **Cupboards**
- **Chests of drawers**
- **Bookcases**
- **Sofas**

Any upholstered items need to have the original label attached that shows the material meets fire regulations. We cannot accept electrical items or white goods (for example fridges or washing machines).

Contact Lesley Edwards on 0800 83 84 81 if you would like to donate an item. Collection will be arranged for September 2009.

Family Festival Fun



This year's Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival is set to be a great day out for all the family. Entrance is free so make sure you stop by at Birchmere Park on Saturday 11th July 2009 from 10am until 6pm. There is so much to do you won't want to leave!

Exciting performances

The T Factor finals, featuring six Thamesmead residents, will be taking place on the main stage this year. The lucky winner will support the headline act on the day and enjoy a recording session at Abbey Music Studios. The main stage will also showcase a Flamenco and African band and tribute acts including High Skool Musicool, Take That 2 and The Great Pretender with Brian Rock and the HRH Band. And if that wasn't enough, Laura White from ITV1's The X Factor will also be performing!

Top festival zones

In the Activity Zone discover the wide range of Thamesmead community groups and local organisations offering performances and demos; from massages to climbing and majorettes to football. Who would have thought so much goes on every day in Thamesmead?!

There will be fun and games all day for the under 5's in the Children's Zone, with everything from face painting to inflatables, arts and crafts to sand/water play. All this and more; with so much excitement the little ones are bound to go home happy and ready for a good night's sleep.







This year the festival site includes the Water Activity Zone at Birchmere Lake (behind the main stage) where the guys from Thamesmead YMCA Sailing Centre will be offering taster sailing sessions. Give it a go – you might take to it like a duck to water!

Unmissable activities

At 1pm and 3.30pm Chocolate Films will be giving you the unique chance to see films from the early days of Thamesmead including the first ever film of the development in the 60s. This event is being filmed for an upcoming documentary, so come along, eat some popcorn and share your memories and opinions on camera.

The Thamesmead parade is back and with up to 400 primary school pupils, community groups and residents taking part, it will be a carnival to remember. Starting at Hawksmoor Primary School at 9:30am and arriving at Birchmere Park to parade around before appearing on the Community Platform at 10:30am as part of a fashion parade.

Make sure you check out the brand new farmyard area this year! There will be goats, ducks, geese, a sheep dog, guinea pigs, rabbits all for you to stroke and touch. And with donkey rides too, the farmyard will be a real treat!

Meet the Trust

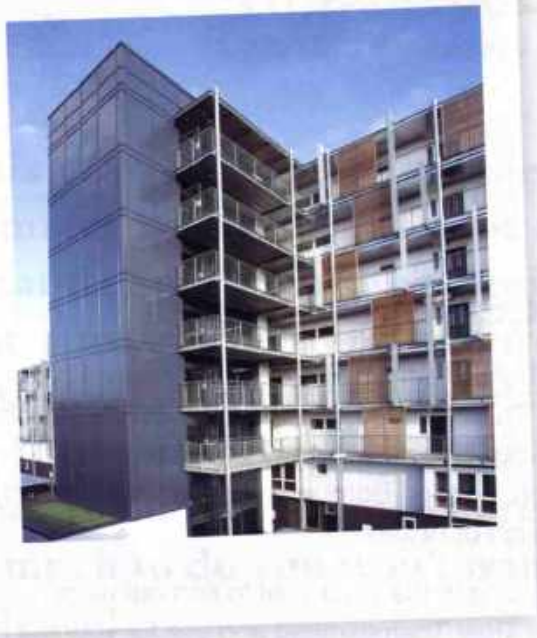
The Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival is run by Trust Thamesmead and is supported by Gallions Housing Association, Axis, Tilfen Land, London City Airport, London Borough of Greenwich and London Borough of Bexley.

Pop along to the Trust Tent to find out more about Trust Thamesmead and see for yourself the fantastic multi-million pound projects the team will be bringing to Thamesmead in the next couple of years, including the world-class Youth Leisure Zone and the spectacular Sporting Club Thamesmead.

TRUST.
THAMESMEAD

SUMMER FESTIVAL
BIRCHMERE PARK
2009

Try before you buy!



If you are having trouble getting a mortgage without a deposit, want to try renting a home before making the commitment to buy or would like to take your first steps on the property ladder we can help with the Rent to HomeBuy scheme.

Rent to HomeBuy is a government supported initiative that could help you buy a great new home, with the flexibility to rent now and buy later. The Rent to HomeBuy scheme means you rent a property for 20% less than the usual market rent agreed for that property. The scheme is designed to give you time to save enough money for a deposit to buy the property later. After 3 years you could apply to buy a share in the property. If you can afford it and we can offer the option at that time, you could buy part of the property under the New Build HomeBuy (shared ownership) scheme. You'll need to be able to pay for at least 25 per cent of the property through savings and/or a mortgage.

The Rent to HomeBuy scheme is open to households earning less than £60,000 a year who would otherwise be unable to buy a home. To find out if you are eligible and for full conditions contact Kelly Beech on 0800 83 84 81.

Fire safety tips

It is extremely important that you protect your home from fires and you are appropriately insured if an incident does happen. Read our top five tips to help protect your home and family:

1. **Fit smoke alarms and test them regularly**
2. **Plan an escape route and keep exits clear so that your family can leave quickly if there is a fire**
3. **Take extra care in the kitchen and never leave the kitchen unattended when cooking**
4. **Don't overload plug sockets**
5. **Make sure you have adequate contents insurance to protect your belongings**



For more information about fire safety contact the London Fire Brigade on 0208 555 1200 or visit www.london-fire.gov.uk/SafetyAtHome. In an emergency always call 999. Contact us on 0800 83 84 81 if you need help with applying for contents insurance.

Get debt free

There is lots of help available if you are having trouble managing on a budget or need help dealing with debt. There are six local agencies, including Gallions, that provide free advice and support for money worries.

1. **Gallions Housing Association Benefits Health Check**
   Harrow Manor Way
   Thamesmead SE2 9XH
   Call: 0800 83 84 81 for an appointment

2. **Greenwich Money Advice Service**
   (Greenwich residents)
   Mulberry Childrens Centre
   Abbey Wood SE2 9JP
   Drop in: Mondays 10am-11am

3. **Citizens Advice Bureau drop-in service**
   Thamesmead Library
   Binsey Walk
   Tavy Bridge
   Thamesmead SE2 9TS
   Drop in: Thursdays 2.15pm-3.30pm

4. **Woolwich Citizens Advice Bureau** (Greenwich residents)
   Old Town Hall
   Polytechnic Street
   Woolwich London SE18 6PN
   Contact: 08451 20 29 31 or greenwichcabbtopenworld.com for advice or an appointment

5. **Erith Citizens Advice Bureau**
   (Bexley residents)
   Pier Road
   Erith
   Kent DA8 1TA
   Contact: 01322 357933 or advice@erithcab.org.uk
   for advice or an appointment

6. **Cross Street Law Centre - formerly Thamesmead Law Centre** (SE2 and SE28 Greenwich & Bexley residents and Bexley borough)
   4 Cross Street
   Erith Kent DA8 1RB
   Call: 020 8311 0555 for advice or an appointment

There are also some great national organisations that can provide free and impartial advice:

Credit Action
Money management information is available via their user friendly website. Click: www.creditaction.org.uk

National Debt Line
Provides free, confidential and independent advice on how to deal with debt problems.
Contact: 0808 808 4000 or www.nationaldebtline.co.uk

Consumer Credit Counselling Service
A free debt help service.
Call: 0800 138 1111 Monday to Friday 8am-8pm

And don't forget that there are still copies of the free Quids In money advice magazine available at Gallions reception in Harrow Manor Way!

Pay before you go

Before you take a break this summer make sure pay your rent. There are lots of ways to pay so it's easier than ever to keep up to date with your payments. You can pay by the following methods:

Standing order - Contact us on 0800 83 84 81 or pop into reception to pick up a form.

Direct Debit - Call us on 0800 83 84 81 with your bank account number and sort code and we will set up the direct debit for you.

Telephone – You can now make payments on the phone 24 hours a day, 365 days a week. Call us on 0800 83 84 81 with your debit and credit card and we will take your payment.

Online - You can make debit or credit card payments 24 hours a day, 365 days a year via a link on our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk.

Post Office or local shop - You can make a payment at any Post Office or shop displaying the PayPoint sign.

Post - Send a cheque or postal orders to Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London SE2 9BR but please leave enough time for the payment to clear.

If you are having difficulty paying your rent we can help. Contact us as soon as possible on 0800 83 84 81 and we will give you advice about getting back on track.

Free first aid course

Gallions has teamed up with first aid experts, the British Red Cross, to offer you a free two hour first aid session. In just two hours you will gain the confidence and knowledge to make a real difference in a emergency. The courses are available for adults (or those aged 16+ with consent from a parent or guardian), who live in the London Borough of Greenwich. You will learn key life saving skills including how to:

- **Lift the chin to open the airway**
- **Give effective rescue breaths**
- **Perform chest compressions**
- **Deal with significant blood loss**

The courses will take place at Gallions Community Atrium, Teeswater Court, Mangold Way on Friday 31st July 2009. Between 10am and 12pm the course will focus on emergency first aid for babies and children. From 1pm until 3pm the course will cover emergency first aid for adults. Contact Kelly Sullivan on 0800 83 84 81 or email ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk to register your interest by Friday 17th July 2009.



Gallions Annual Residents Conference 2009

Make a note in your diary for the next Gallions Annual Residents Conference which promises to be bigger and better than ever before. The event will be held on Saturday 10th October 2009 at Bexley Business Academy, Yarnton Way.

More details about the conference will be released later in the summer. To register your interest or find out more about the day's activities contact Marie Dunster on 0800 83 84 81 or email mdunster@gallionsha.co.uk.



SPOTLIGHT ON

Green Chain Walk activities

Back in 1977 four London Boroughs and the Greater London Council got together to create 'The South East London Green Chain', a linked system of open spaces across Bexley, Bromley, Lewisham and Greenwich. Today there are nearly 300 Green Chain protected open spaces which include some of the finest landscapes in South East London and cover an area the same size as 2500 football pitches!

The Green Chain team run lots of free guided walks throughout the year that anyone can join in with to get active, enjoy local scenery and meet new people. Their annual walking festival, which will run from 12th – 20th September this year, is a great opportunity for you to experience the very best of London's open spaces!

To find out more visit www.greenchain.com or call 0208 921 5028.

For little ones (under 5)

Greenmead Children's Centre, Lime Row (off Yarnton Way), telephone Tel: 020 8320 1618

Goose-e-ganders parent and toddler group, Broadwater Village Hall, telephone 07958 640645

Toddles, Manor Close Community Hall, Manor Close. Term time, Monday to Friday 9.30am until 11.30am and 12.30pm until 2.30pm.

Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School, Senior Citizens Hall, Tavy Bridge, telephone 07950 853481

Lighthouse Parent and Toddler Group, Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Wednesdays and Fridays 1.30pm until 3pm.

Young Foundations Pre-School, Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Monday until Friday 9.30am until 12 noon.

Toy Library, Linton Mead Primary School, Central Way, telephone 0208 310 1902, Friday 9am until 11am, term time only, for under 5s.

Discovery Children's Centre, Battery Road, telephone 0208 855 4320, Monday, Wednesday and Thursday 9am until 4pm and Tuesday and Friday 9am until 1.30pm.

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

For bigger ones

The cAve climbing wall, Arch 3, Harrow Manor Way, telephone 0208 320 4494, www.trust-thamesmeadcave.co.uk, Monday to Friday 4pm until 7pm and weekends 1.30pm until 5.30pm, everyone aged 4+.

Fun Club, Glimpsing Green, telephone 0208 311 6777, Saturday mornings, for under 11s with a disability.

JMF Support Group, Jubilee Hall, Lytton Strachey Path, telephone 0208 310 5885, Saturday 1pm until 3pm

Rainbows, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for 5 to 7 year olds.

Rainbows, Abbey Wood Community Centre, 4 Knee Hill, telephone 0208 311 2239, Wednesday 4.45pm until 6pm, for 5 to 7 year olds

Brownies and Guides, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for girls aged 7+.

Brownies, Greenmead Community Centre, telephone 07960 815229, Every Tuesday from 6pm, Girls age 7 to 10.

New Acres Library, Tavy Bridge, telephone 0208 311 5291, for all young people, from babies to teenagers.

Hawksmoor Youth Club, Bentham Road, telephone 0208 312 4022

Heronsgate Youth Club, Whinchat Road, 07950 612826

Performing Arts

Dynamix, Bexley Business Academy, Yarnton Way, telephone 07796 450093, for ages 6 to 20

Theatre Street, Broadwater Village Hall, Gooseander Way, telephone 01322 441977, www.theatrestreet.com, tots to adults

Youth Advisory Project, 12 Tavy Bridge, telephone 0208 311 5111, for 16 to 24 year olds

Young at Heart

Monday Club Bingo, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

Over 50s Bingo Club, Greenmead Community Hall, Lime Row, telephone 0208 310 0240, Monday and Thursday 7pm until 9pm

Rendezvous Club, Evenlode House, Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s

The Atrium Community Centre, Teeswater Court, telephone 0800 83 84 81, 7 days a week. Fun and free over 50s keep fit classes run Wednesday 4.30pm until 5.30pm

Just for Fun!



Take some time out to enjoy our brainteasers. Remember you only have to complete the wordsearch for the chance to win a prize.

1 Holiday quiz

Whether you are having a 'staycation' this year or jetting off somewhere sunny this quiz will test your holiday knowledge.

A. What is the French speciality of escargot made of?

_____

B. In which English coastal town is the Eden Project attraction?

_____

C. Which is the biggest Greek Island?

_____

D. What does 'helado' mean in Spanish?

_____

2 Linking up

The Greenwich and Bexley Hospice will be having a fun teddy bear's picnic this summer. Use the clues and change one letter at a time to turn the word 'bear' into 'moon'. We have done the first one for you.

Bear - large furry mammal

_____ ***- expensive***

_____ ***- a member of the clergy***

_____ ***- rest against something***

_____ ***- borrowed money***

_____ ***- to grumble***

Moon

Answers:
1. a) Frogs legs b) Cornwall. c) Crete d) Ice cream
2. Dear, dean, lean, loan, moan

3 Festival wordsearch

At this year's Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival there will be an amazing farmyard for kids. Find all the farm related words in this wordsearch for the chance to win a £25 Morrisons voucher.

Tractor **Farmer** **Fields**

Pigs **Cows** **Sheep**

O	S	Y	U	E	M	D	S	V	W	O	P
T	S	A	T	E	T	A	D	A	U	E	L
O	E	T	R	A	C	T	O	R	E	A	U
T	N	O	H	E	I	H	P	H	C	I	L
A	Y	E	R	T	F	R	S	I	O	I	T
N	R	O	O	E	A	M	A	B	G	W	G
P	U	Y	N	E	R	A	D	T	S	S	I
C	O	W	S	D	M	P	G	D	T	N	N
E	I	T	S	T	E	K	L	T	T	E	A
O	B	D	H	H	R	E	E	T	R	M	E
S	F	E	T	T	I	R	E	F	H	C	O
O	E	I	D	F	W	Y	Y	M	H	S	A

Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR or drop it into our reception by 14 August 2009. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: _____

Address: _____

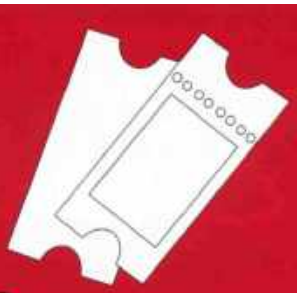
Telephone: _____

Email: _____

Congratulations to Miss Diep of Maran Way who was selected as the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Events Calendar

There are exciting things happening in your area.



July 2009

Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival 11 July

Don't miss out on the party of the year at Birchmere Park! With amazing live music, a special water activities zone and a fantastic farmyard there really is something for everyone.

Need more details? The Annual Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival will be open from 10am until 6pm and is free to attend. Check out pages 4-5 of the magazine for more details or visit www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk

Greenwich and Bexley Cottage Hospice Funday 12 July

Come along to Bostall Heath Playing Field, Bostall Hill for a great day out for all the family with stalls, sideshows, arena events, entertainment and much, much more.

Need more details? Call Greenwich & Bexley Cottage Hospice on 020 8312 2244 or visit www.cottagehospice.org.uk.

Hospice Lottery first draw 31 July

The first draw for the newly established Lottery in support of the Greenwich & Bexley Cottage Hospice will take place on this day. This lottery will help to raise funds to support the very special work of the Hospice.

Need more details? To sign up as a player call Greenwich and Bexley Cottage Hospice on 020 8312 2244 or visit www.cottagehospice.org.uk

August 2009

Play Day 5 August

Join Gallions, Trust Thamesmead and Bexley Youth Services, with funding from Bexley Extended Services, fora really fun day! There will be lots of exciting activities for children, young adults and their families between 11am and 3pm at the Southlake Centre, Seacourt Road.

Need more details? Call us on 0800 83 84 81 or visit www.gallionsha.co.uk.

Ramadan begins 22 August

During Ramadan Muslims fast from dawn until sunset to celebrate when the verses of the Qur'an were revealed to the Prophet Muhammed.

'Drop in' at the Secret Garden Wildlife Centre 26 August

Pop along to the Secret Garden Wildlife Centre at Greenwich Park between 10am and 4pm to enjoy local wildlife spotting and fun activities for all ages.

Need more details? Visit www.royalparks.org.uk or call 0207 298 2079.

Bank Holiday Monday 31 August

Enjoy the last bank holiday of the summer.

Events Calendar

There are exciting things happening in your area.



September 2009

Green Chain Walking Festival
12-20 September

Join in with the annual walking festival this September and discover more about where you live. Each of the free guided walks has been carefully selected to show the best of the Green Chain.

Need more details? Pick up a free festival programme from your local library, call 0208 921 5025 or visit www.greenchain.com to find out more.

Teddy Bears Picnic
13 September

Pop along to the Greenwich and Bexley Hospice at 185 Bostall Hill, Abbey Wood from 1.30pm until 4.30pm for a truly magical afternoon. This event is especially for the kids with a children's entertainer, stalls, games, fun, competitions, BBQ and more. Don't forget your teddy!

Need more details? Call Greenwich & Bexley Cottage Hospice On 020 8312 2244 or visit www.cottagehospice.org.uk

Rosh Hashanah
19-20 September

This holiday celebrates the Jewish New Year.

Eid-ul-Fitr
20 September

This occasion marks the end of Ramadan for Muslims.

New homes for Gallions

Gallions has recently finished work on two great new housing developments, where we will soon be welcoming new Gallions residents.

Lakeview Court is an extra care sheltered housing scheme in Thamesmere Drive, near to Thamesmead town centre. Gallions has been working with the London Borough of Greenwich and Denne Construction to create these new homes, which are especially for older people who need a little more support to live independently. There are 50 one and two bed properties available. If you or a family member would like to apply for a home please contact our Allocations and Lettings team on 0800 83 84 81.



Millaharbour is a cutting edge housing scheme in South Quays, Tower Hamlets. The one and two bedroom apartments have great river views and they are very close to the DLR. These properties are only available to residents referred to us from the Tower Hamlets housing waiting list.

Gas safety checks for tenants

As your landlord, Gallions is legally obliged to carry out an annual safety check on all of the fixed gas appliances in your property, inlcuding boilers. Faulty gas appliances can be a serious risk to the health and safety of you, your family and neighbours. You could be at risk of carbon monoxide posioning or a possible explosion if your fixed gas appliances are unsafe. It is extremely important that you allow our contractor (Interserve) access to your home to carry out a check. Interserve will contact you to make an appointment when a check is due.

If you do not allow us to complete a gas safety check you could be at risk of repossession. Look out for a letter marked 'This letter could save your life' or a yellow sticker like the one featured - if you receive either of these you must contact us straightaway on 0800 83 84 81. If you are a leaseholder you should arrange your own gas safety inspections.



Your guide to repairs and maintenance



Gallions works with Axis to repair and maintain your home.

We work as a partnership to make sure you get the best possible service. We have worked with residents to create ambitious performance targets for our repairs and maintenance service. We're pleased to say those targets have been consistently achieved or bettered, which includes more home repairs completed on the first visit and a greater number of properties being delivered to the 'Decent Homes' standard than anticipated.

Throughout the next year and beyond we will be altering the way we work to help improve the service you receive. Axis will be changing their IT systems, giving staff extra customer service and technical training as well as working out how long components will last, to ensure we're achieving as much as possible with the budget available.



And that's just the beginning.

Your home is in good hands, we're making it our job to improve on our 98% resident satisfaction rate as we continue to deliver high standards of repair, maintenance and improvement services.

We really welcome your feedback and know that by working together we can improve what we do and deliver what is important to you. Contact the communications team on 0800 83 84 81 to find out how to get involved .

How did we do in 2008/09?

194 New kitchens
286 New bathrooms
198 Rewires

How did we do in 2008/09?

71 Properties had windows replaced
266 Homes had roofs repaired or replaced
193 Properties received external decoration
192 Homes received rewired block lighting

Find out more

0800 83 84 81
gallionsha.co.uk
axiseurope.com

Gallions Housing Association

working together

axis

Thamesview Survey results

Thank you to everyone that took the time to complete the Thamesview questionnaire included with the April edition. We received almost 100 replies and many of you shared some really exciting ideas with us.

We will be including your suggestions wherever we can in future issues of the magazine – look out for the yellow 'reader idea' symbol as this shows where we have changed the magazine because of your feedback. The surveys showed:

Your three favourite sections are: Your Community, Events Calendar and Gallions and You.

98% of you think the magazine is informative

27 of you said that you wouldn't change a single thing about the magazine!

96% of you think the magazine looks good

If you would like to join the Thamesview Editorial Team and help put the magazine together contact Anita Dagger on 0800 83 84 81.

How clean are our homes?

Gallions is working with Keep Britain Tidy, an organisation that helps companies improve environmental standards, to enhance the surroundings in our neighbourhoods.

At the moment we carry out external assessments to monitor levels of cleanliness on our land but from this month we will be looking at the cleansing quality in internal communal areas too.

Every two months we will be checking windows, floors, lights and bin areas to see how clean they are. We will use this information to make changes and improve standards for our residents.

Contact the communications team on 0800 83 84 81 or email communications@gallionsha.co.uk to find out more.

Latest news for Leaseholders

Understanding APR, AER and EAR

When you purchase using credit or take out a loan they provide information about interest rates. However it is not always clear how much you will be paying.

APR (annual percentage rate).

This tells you how much your borrowing via mortgage, personal loan or credit card, will cost over the course of a year, as a proportion of the amount you have borrowed. So if you are borrowing £100 at an APR of 9%, you will pay £9 in interest and charges over the first year.

In a loan advert a provider will often quote a "typical APR" – this is because many lenders set the actual interest rate charged according to the borrower's credit record and personal circumstances. A bank has to have offered its "typical APR" (or a better rate) to 66% of customers.

In a mortgage advert, there will be a headline rate as well as the APR. Most lenders charge administration fees on mortgages so APR's tend to be much higher than the headline rates.

EAR (equivalent annual rate).

This is quoted when you are borrowing money as an overdraft. It gives you an idea of how much your borrowing will cost if you remain overdrawn for a year.

The calculations take into account the rate of interest being charged, how often it is charged and the effect of compounding it – charging interest on interest – over the year.

AER (annual equivalent rate)

This is quoted on savings accounts. It is like the EAR but refers to interest earned rather than interest paid. It tells you how much interest you will earn over the course of a year and takes into account how often the interest is paid and what effect compounding will have.

This allows you to compare accounts and work out where your savings will earn the most.

Sub-letting: information for shared owners

Our regulators state that shared ownership sub-leases must prohibit sub-letting to protect public funds and ensure applicants are not entering shared ownership for commercial gain.

Gallions may consider requests to sub-let on a case by case basis. It is our decision as to whether we agree to a request and you cannot sub-let unless we accept your application. We have to consider the following criteria:

- Do the reasons for sub-letting genuinely stem from unavoidable need and not for speculation or gain?
- Does the person(s) to whom the leaseholder sublets also satisfy the criteria for shared ownership?
- Are the terms for the sublet for a fixed period after which the lease must revert back to the original shared owner?
- Does the leaseholder have the permission of the mortgage lender?

Any leaseholder or shared owner who is given permission to sublet must comply with Gas Safety Regulations 1998 and Furniture and Furnishings (Fire) (Safety) Regulations 1998 amended in 1989 and 1993 and the Electrical Equipment (safety) Regulations 1994. Battery or hard wired smoke detectors should also be provided.

We are advised by our buildings insurer that if you are sub-letting your property and do not have a proper legal tenancy agreement in place, you will not be covered in the event of a claim.

If a shared owner is sub-letting without permission, any tenancy agreement they give their tenant is not a legal document since under the terms of the shared ownership lease, they are not allowed to sublet.

Defects

If you have bought a new property you will have been told about defects and how to report them. Twelve months after handover from the developer to Gallions, an inspection is carried out; and any defects put right by the builder. It is really important that you highlight any problems you have with your property and also that you make yourself available for this inspection since anything not listed at that time will not be attended to.

Any residents experiencing leaks from integrated kitchen appliance connections such as washing machines should engage their own plumber in the first instance to investigate. A subsequent plumbers report can then be used to make a claim against contractors through Gallions for any potential latent defects.

As this can prove to be a lengthy process to resolve with no guaranteed outcome of any third party accepting liability it is also advisable to make a claim through your contents insurance policy so that any necessary works are carried out straight away and then claimed back by your insurer.

Repairs responsibilities

Leaseholders and shared owners have fully repairing leases. This means you are responsible for all repairs inside your home once the twelve month defect period has expired, including the electrical, plumbing and heating systems.

Gallions are responsible for the structure of the building and communal areas in blocks of flats.

Contact us

Call the leasehold team on 0800 83 84 81 if you have any questions about repairs, defect or sub-letting.

Send us your letters!

We would love to introduce a special reader's page in the next issue of Thamesview and need you to write or email us with your issues, comments and suggestions.

We think that a page dedicated to our residents would give you the opportunity to give your views, ask important questions and share your great ideas.

Email thamesview@gallionsha.co.uk or write to Thamesview, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR. We will publish as many letters as we can.



Thank you to R and S Kincella of Aspen Green and S Robinson of Sunset Road for their ideas about introducing a page for residents' views.

At Gallions we celebrate the diversity of our neighbourhoods. We offer a comprehensive translation service to make communicating with us easy. If you would like this issue of Thamesview magazine translated into your own language please contact us. You can call 0800 83 84 81, email translations@gallionsha.co.uk or visit our office at Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. We can translate documents into any language and have audio, large print and Braille options available.

ਗੈਲੀਅਨਜ਼ ਵਿਚ ਅਸੀਂ ਆਪਣੇ ਇਲਾਕਿਆਂ ਵਿਚਲੇ ਵਖਰੇਵਿਆਂ ਦੀ ਕਦਰ ਕਰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਗੱਲ ਬਾਤ ਕਰਨਾ ਸੌਖਾ ਬਣਾਉਣ ਲਈ ਅਸੀਂ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਰਨ ਦੀ ਮੁਕੰਮਲ ਸਹੂਲਤ ਦਿੰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਜੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਆਪਣੇ ਘਰ ਦੀ ਸਾਂਝੀ ਮਲਕੀਅਤ ਨੂੰ ਵੇਚਣ ਬਾਰੇ ਇਸ ਪਰਚੇ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਆਪਣੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਵਿਚ ਕਰਵਾਉਣਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕਰੋ। ਤੁਸੀਂ ਸਾਨੂੰ ਨੰਬਰ 0800 83 84 81 'ਤੇ ਫ਼ੋਨ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ, ਜਾਂ ਇਸ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਲੈਟਰ ਭੇਜ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ translations@gallionsha.co.uk ਜਾਂ ਅੱਗੇ ਦੱਸੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਦਫ਼ਤਰ ਵਿਚ ਮੁਲਾਕਾਤ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ - Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. ਅਸੀਂ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ਾਂ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਿਸੇ ਵੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਵਿਚ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹਾਂ, ਅਤੇ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਸੁਣਨ ਵਾਲੀ ਟੇਪ 'ਤੇ, ਵੱਡੇ ਅੱਖਰਾਂ ਵਿਚ ਅਤੇ ਬ੍ਰੇਲ ਵਿਚ ਵੀ ਦੇ ਸਕਦੇ ਹਾਂ।

Chúng tôi vui mừng vì sự đa dạng về dân cư ở Gallions. Chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ dịch thuật toàn diện để tạo điều kiện dễ dàng cho quí vị liên lạc với chúng tôi. Nếu quí vị muốn dịch số này của cuốn Tạp chí Thamesview sang ngôn ngữ của quí vị, hãy liên hệ với chúng tôi. Quí vị có thể gọi điện thoại theo số 0800 83 84 81, gửi thư điện tử theo địa chỉ translations@gallionsha.co.uk hoặc đến văn phòng của chúng tôi tại Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. Chúng tôi có thể dịch các tài liệu sang bất kỳ ngôn ngữ nào và luôn sẵn có các lựa chọn khác như ghi âm, in khổ lớn và chữ nổi.

格莱恩斯房屋協會 (Gallions) 頌揚我們鄰舍地區的多元化面貌。我們提供全面的翻譯服務，以便他們與我們進行溝通。如欲要求我們把本期的 Thamesview 雜誌翻譯成繁體中文 (廣東話)，請告訴我們。你可以致電 0800 83 84 81、發送電郵到 translations@gallionsha.co.uk，或親臨我們位於 Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH 的辦事處提出要求。我們可以將文件翻譯成任何語文，也備有語音、特大字體和凸字版本，以供選擇。

Punjabi ◯ **Vietnamese** ◯ **Chinese** ◯
(Please tick one)

Name .....

Address .....

Return to: Anita Dagger, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association Harrow Mannor Way, London SE2 9XH.

Noticeboard

Thamesmead in Bloom for 2009

Thamesmead in Bloom, your local gardening competition, has been more popular than ever this year. We are currently judging the best gardens and the prettiest balconies in the area and we will soon be announcing the winners. Check out our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or call us on 0800 83 84 81 for the winner details. We will publish photos of the winning gardens in the autumn edition of Thamesview.



Your home: something to talk about

Gallions recently held two National Conversatio events so that our residents could have their sa about housing and help shape the standards fo the newly created Tenant Services Authority (th regulator of affordable housing).

We had a great response and our residents told us their views on a whole range of topics including repairs, estate cleanliness and anti-social behaviour. All the responses were collected anonymously and sent to the Tenant Services Authority to be included in their research. The full results will be published soor

To find out more about the National Conversati visit www.tenantservicesauthority.org or call 08 230 7000. If you would like to get involved with Gallions contact our Neighbourhood Projects Team on 0800 83 84 81.

Tavy Bridge update

At the end of May the Tavy Bridge Regeneration Project Office at 6-8 Tavy Bridge was closed. All of our staff have relocated to our main office at Harrow Manor Way. If you want to get in touch with the team call them on 0800 83 84 81.

Wonderful things on our website

You can access many of our services 24 hours a day on our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk. From rent payment and repair reporting to searching for mutual exchanges and community events you can find out lots of information online at your leisure. Check out our website today or call us on 0800 83 84 81 to find out more about what we have to offer.



Gallions shortlisted for three awards

Gallions has recently been shortlisted f three London Excellence Awards in the Results Focus and People Involvement and Development categories along wit the Ambassadors' Blue Riband Award

We are really hoping to be selected as overall winners for the second year in a row; having collected two London Excellence Awards (Leadership and Making Partnerships Work) last year. We will find out if we have scooped th awards on the 13th July. Find out mo on our website at www.gallionsha.co. or call the Communications Team on 0800 83 84 81.



Employment and Training information event

Gallions' Neighbourhood Projects team held an employment and training event at Thamesmere Leisure Centre in May. Many residents came along to get advice from GLLaB (Greenwich Local Labour and Business), Greenwich Community College, Aspire, Bexley College and Building Futures. More than 30 residents signed up with Hays Recruitment to access the latest job opportunities. Let us know if you would like to come along to the next event by calling 0800 83 84 81.



Greener Neighbourhoods for everyone

Gallions is working in partnership with other social landlords, Groundworks, London Wildlife Trust and Natural England on a bid to improve some of our green spaces. If we are successful with the bid – called Neighbourhoods Green – we will be able to develop a programme of activities to help our residents really enjoy the local green spaces. The types of projects we may be able to offer include growing vegetables, creating flower meadows and installing bird and bat boxes.

We will keep you informed about the progress of the bid in future issues of Thamesview. For more information contact Susan Asquith, Senior Neighbourhood Projects Officer on 0800 83 84 81, email sasquith@gallionsha.co.uk or check out the Neighbourhoods Green website at www.neighbourhoodsgreen.org.uk.

Careers at Gallions

Details of our current employment opportunities are publicised on our website and at our reception desk. Please get in touch on 0800 83 84 81 if you are interested in a career with us.

Complaints and contacts

Gallions aims to provide a first class service to all its residents. However, if you are unhappy with the service you have received there is a policy in place to help you make a complaint. A guide is available on our website.

Complaints@gallionsha.co.uk

www.gallionsha.co.uk

0800 83 84 81

Thamesview publication details

Thamesview is published by Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH and is free to Gallions' residents and anyone else who wishes to obtain a copy.

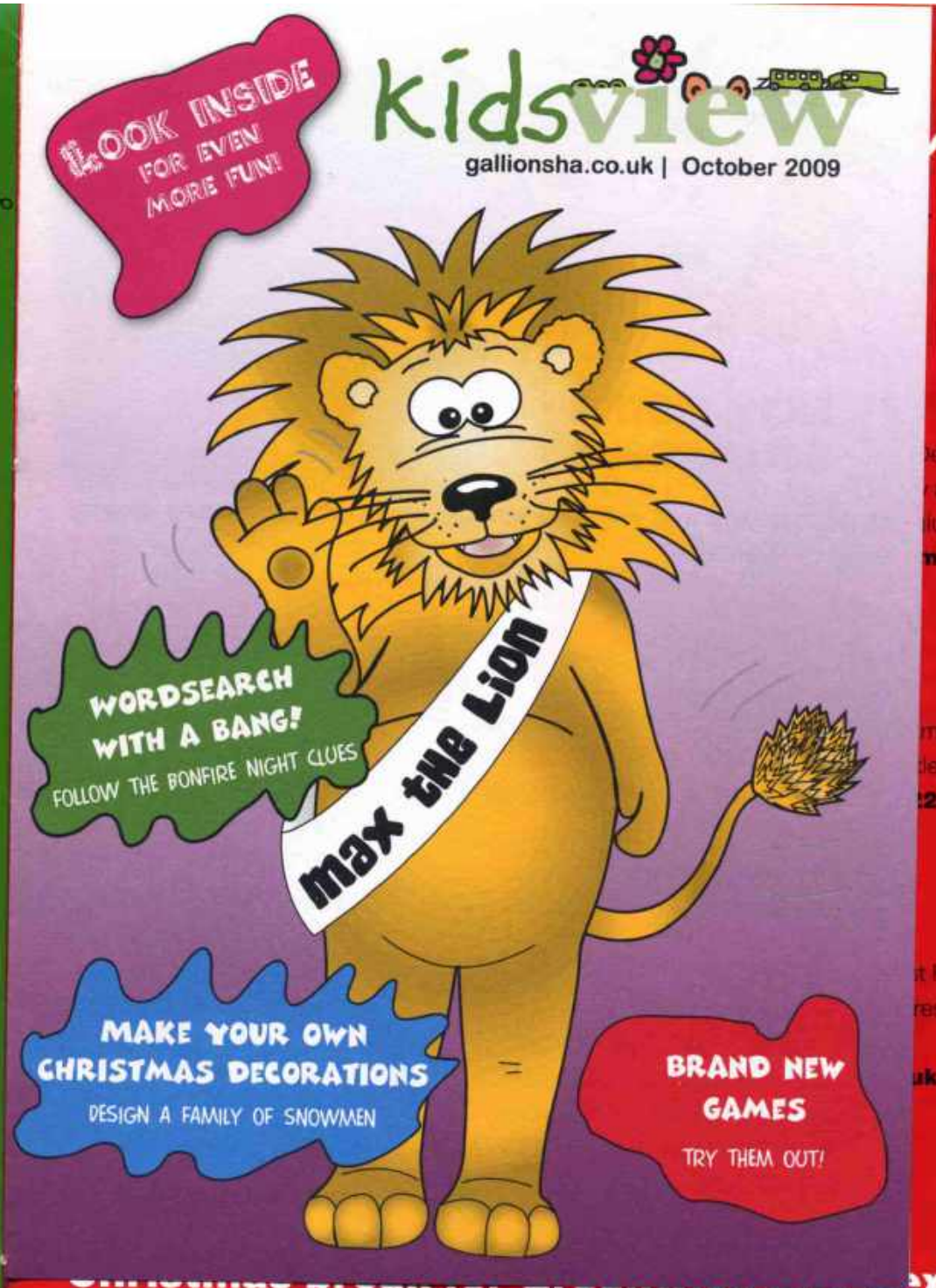
Don't forget your rent this summer



Pay before you go.

orbit
ORBIT SOUTH
0800 678 1221

Gallions
Housing Association
0800 83 84 81



21 December - 1 January

Christmas Day (Christian)
25 December



HI!

WELCOME BACK TO KIDSVIEW! I HOPE YOU HAVE FUN MAKING GORGEOUS CHRISTMAS DECORATIONS, TRYING OUR NEW GAMES AND DOING THE BONFIRE NIGHT WORDSEARCH. STAY IN CONTACT BY EMAILING ME AT MAXTHELION@GALLIONSHA.CO.UK

EASY FESTIVE DECORATIONS

GET TOGETHER WITH YOUR FRIENDS OR BROTHERS AND SISTERS TO MAKE THESE FANTASTIC SNOWMEN CHARACTERS.

YOU WILL NEED:



1 PIECE OF WHITE A4 PAPER
30CM OF THREAD OR STRING
ASSORTED BUTTONS, BEADS OR SEQUINS
RIBBON
BLACK AND ORANGE PENS
SCISSORS
GLUE

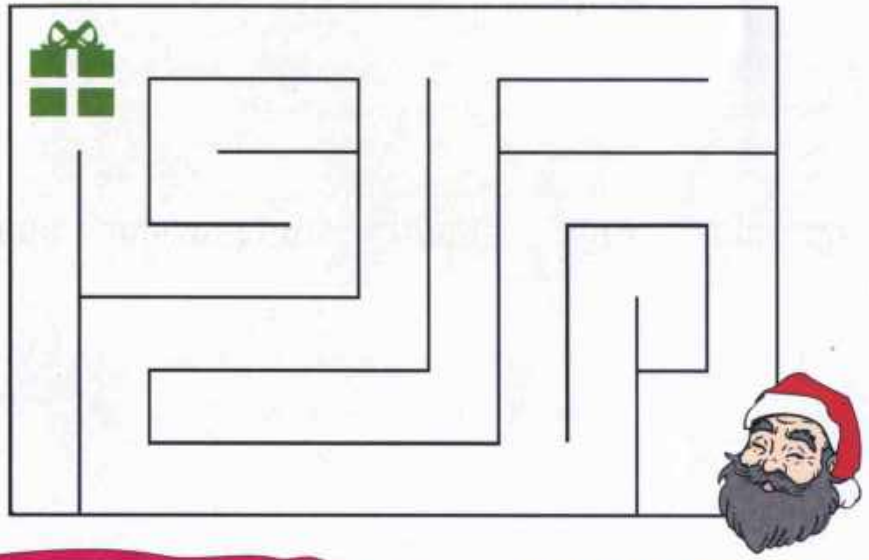
INSTRUCTIONS:

1. DRAW 3 CIRCLES ON THE WHITE PAPER; ONE SMALL, ONE MEDIUM AND ONE LARGE. YOU CAN USE A COMPASS (WITH SUPERVISION FROM AN ADULT) OR DIFFERENT SIZED JAR LIDS.
2. CAREFULY CUT OUT EACH OF THE CIRCLES. YOU CAN RECYCLE THE LEFTOVER PAPER.
3. MAKE A LOOP AT ONE END OF THE STRING FOR HANGING ON THE TREE.
4. LINE THE CIRCLES UP WITH THE SMALLEST AT THE TOP AND THE BIGGEST AT THE BOTTOM AND PUT A LINE OF GLUE DOWN THE MIDDLE OF EACH CIRCLE. STICK THE STRING TO IT, KEEPING THE LOOP ABOVE THE SMALLER CIRCLE. ALLOW TO DRY.
5. TURN THE CIRCLES OVER. ON THE SMALLER CIRCLE DRAW EYES AND A MOUTH WITH THE BLACK PEN. WITH THE ORANGE PEN DRAW THE NOSE.
6. CUT THE RIBBON TO SIZE AND TIE A BOW BETWEEN THE SMALL CIRCLE AND THE MEDIUM CIRCLE.
7. PICK YOUR FAVOURITE BUTTONS/BEADS/SEQUINS AND STICK THEM ALONG THE MIDDLE OF THE MEDIUM AND LARGE CIRCLES.
8. HANG ON THE TREE THIS DECEMBER!



FATHER CHRISTMAS TRAIL

FATHER CHRISTMAS HAS DROPPED A PRESENT ON HIS TRAVELS. CAN YOU HELP HIM FIND IT BY DRAWING THE WAY ON THIS MAP?



A WITCH'S SPELL

UNSCRAMBLE THESE WORDS RELATING TO THE WITCH'S PICTURES.

1. MROOB KCSTI 
2. LBKAC TAC 
3. LOCKA 
4. TYOINP THA 

ANSWERS
1) BROOM STICK 2) BLACK CAT 3) CLOAK 4) POINTY HAT

Gallions Housing Association

COOL COMPETITION!

"REMEMBER, REMEMBER THE FIFTH OF NOVEMBER!"

Can you find all the fireworks night words in this wordsearch?

If you discover all the words send your completed wordsearch and the entry form to us by 20th November for the chance to win a bumper Christmas gift pack.

Sparkler Guy Bonfire Gunpowder Plot



E	S	B	E	O	G	I	T	S	H	E
M	S	P	O	S	U	S	I	O	T	A
E	S	G	A	N	Y	A	O	O	E	R
U	Y	L	U	R	F	E	S	I	L	T
E	N	I	E	N	K	I	E	R	R	R
E	U	T	T	K	P	L	R	V	H	L
H	H	O	A	O	H	O	E	E	I	A
R	L	D	T	E	D	T	W	R	E	E
P	O	E	U	S	F	T	Y	D	O	T
A	S	E	R	Y	T	I	E	O	E	I
X	N	N	S	U	W	N	C	A	L	R

Please return your completed form to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR or drop your entry into our reception by 20th November. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: _____

Name of parent or guardian: _____

Address: _____

_____ Telephone: _____

Congratulations to AMBER OVENELL OF CURLEW CLOSE who was selected as the winner of our last competition!
This competition is open to children under 16 years of age and is free to enter.